

Birds of the Bush

A small field guide to Aotearoa's songbirds

Flipbook demo edition · 2026

Before you set out

The best birding happens early, just after dawn, when the bush is loudest. Walk slowly, stop often, and listen before you look — most native birds announce themselves long before they show themselves.

Each entry in this guide pairs a bird with its te reo Māori name, its scientific name, and a few field notes.

This booklet exists purely to demonstrate a PDF flipbook component. Drag a page corner, or tap near the edge.

No. 01



Tūī

Prosthemadera novaeseelandiae

A boisterous mimic with an iridescent sheen and a distinctive white throat tuft. Its song mixes bell-like notes with clicks, cackles and wheezes. Common in gardens wherever there is nectar.

No. 02



Kererū

Hemiphaga novaeseelandiae

New Zealand's hefty native pigeon, famous for noisy swooping flight and the occasional over-indulgence in fermented fruit. A vital disperser of large native seeds.

No. 03



Pīwakawaka

Rhipidura fuliginosa

The fantail flits restlessly through the understorey, fanning its tail to flush insects. Friendly and curious, it often follows walkers along bush tracks.

No. 04



Kea

Nestor notabilis

The world's only alpine parrot — intelligent, mischievous and entirely unrepentant about dismantling windscreen wipers in carparks across the Southern Alps.

No. 05



Korimako

Anthornis melanura

The bellbird's dawn chorus rings through the bush like struck crystal. Olive-green and easily heard long before it is seen.

No. 06



Ruru

Ninox novaeseelandiae

The morepork keeps watch after dark, named for its mournful two-note call. Aotearoa's only surviving native owl.